

Seaglider Ballasting Checklist

Mission: _____ **Seaglider ID:** _____

Engineer: _____ **Date:** _____

Source

Paraphrased from the APL-UW IOP office-hours session on ballasting and volmax estimation. See the [Ballasting Procedure](#) for the full explanation of each step.

1. Setup

- ☐ Freshwater tank filled, deep enough to fully submerge the glider vertically
- ☐ Hanging scale / load cell rigged over the tank
- ☐ Suspension line ready (ties off at the rudder)
- ☐ Comms cable available and connected, with slack — no surface expression
- ☐ Antenna left disconnected and dangling free

2. Dry Weight

- ☐ Complete glider (wings, rudder, everything) weighed dry — record mass **M**
- ☐ Glider soaked overnight, fully submerged and vertical, in the tank

3. Tank Density

- ☐ Tank temperature recorded (and salinity, if not freshwater)
- ☐ Tank water density computed